ESL Brains

Learning English (first lesson with new students)

1. **In each pair, choose a topic and share some details about it.**

my education and English	**or**	my work and English
my holiday and English	**or**	my free time and English
people I know and English	**or**	my future and English

2. **Choose the correct answers.**

   A. In the next couple of months, I'm going to spend some time **learn/learning/to learn** English every day.

   B. The biggest problem **I had/I have/I've had** with English so far is grammar.

   C. In my industry, speaking English is **as/much/more** important as any other skill.

   D. The main reason I learn English is **in order I can/to be able to/because of I** communicate while travelling.

   E. I don't think English is very difficult, but I believe motivation and hard work **have/might been/are** required to learn it.

   F. If I **could/can /would** either speak English perfectly or write English perfectly, I would choose speaking.

   G. When I can speak English fluently, I **will/would/want** start learning an Asian language next.

   H. People around me **don't used to/didn't use to/didn't used to** speak English as well and as often as they do now.



3. **Look at the statements in ex. 2 again and say which are true for you and which are not. Provide more details.**

4. **Listen to part of a podcast [https://youtu.be/nntNNcprcqk] about English (to 02:24) and answer the questions.**

   A. How is English different from Mandarin Chinese?

   B. What was the role of English in countries which were part of the British Empire?

   C. What happened to the US after the World Wars?

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5. Listen to part of the podcast again (to 01:18) and complete the gaps with two words each.

A. English, as you probably guessed, is the _____ spoken language in the world.

B. But have you ever wondered how the English language became so dominant in _____ place...

C. We're gonna get into the internet side of things in just a sec. I'm gonna _____ by a linguist and AI expert...

D. Hundreds of millions of people around the world. _____ , 1.5 billion people speak English.

E. ... which makes it distinct from other languages because if you _____ to the second most spoken language, Mandarin Chinese...

6. Look at the data from the podcast and do the tasks below.

> 1.5 billion people speak English. Only 400 million of those, or around 25%, are native speakers.

- List three benefits of the situation for English learners.
- List three challenges the situation creates for English learners.

7. Read the sentences (A–H) about people who try to improve their English and complete the gaps with the words in the boxes. In each set, one word is not used.

daily	occasionally	recently

A. She found a job where she uses English on a/an _____ basis.

B. I _____ speak English with friends and family, even those who share my first language.

bring	cover	get

C. When I watch films and shows in English without subtitles, I usually _____ the important parts.

D. She listens to podcasts in English which _____ the topics she's interested in.

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achievement | improvement | increase

E. They've noticed a big _____ in their English skills since they moved to an English-speaking country.

F. I go to English lessons twice a week but they're quite difficult, so completing each task is an _____ for me.

about | of | on

G. He reads three books in English every year to learn a wide range _____ vocabulary.

H. I sometimes comment _____ people's online posts in English.

8. Look at the ways people try to improve their English in ex. 7 again and discuss the questions.

- Which of the things people do to improve their English do you also do? Which have you done in the past?
- In your opinion, which three things are the best to do if you want to improve your English?
- What are some other ways to improve your English?

9. Complete the sentences with your own ideas. Give more details.

- When this course ends, I expect to be able to...
- The English skill I want to improve the most is...
- In every lesson of this course, I'd like to...
- The topic I would like to spend the most time on is...
- I hope the lessons will be...
- I'd like the teacher to...

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